

Problem in dual booting

Q I have the following configuration for my desktop: Pentium D820, Intel D945GNT motherboard, 2 GB DDR2 533MHz RAM, 17-inch LG CRT monitor, 500 GB and 160 GB HDD. I installed Windows XP Professional in a 500-GB drive and Windows 2003 server in 160 GB drive. When I connect both hard disks and switch ON the system, it displays booting display screen with both OSs with server 2003 as first one. When I select server 2003, it works normally, showing both hard drives partitions starting from 160 GB to 500 GB. But when I select Windows XP, the XP logo screen displays for around 10 seconds, then the system restarts and shows the booting screen again. When I remove the 160 GB HDD and switch on the system, XP works normally. I want to make it dual boot with options, such that when I select server 2003 it should show 160 GB HDD, and when I select XP, it should show 500 GB HDD. At least, XP and Server 2003, both should run when I connect both HDD so that I have the option of dual boot.

Edwin Paul Menezes

A The problem you are facing is because of confusion in boot records written on each of the drives and OSs installed on the larger drive. With the 160 GB connected, make sure you have the correct drive booting up from the BIOS. You can also edit the boot.ini file on each of the drives and correct the entries so that you have the right partition and Windows installation booting up.

XP Not Installing

Q My hard disk had crashed, so I bought a new Seagate 160 GB hard disk for my laptop. When I tried to install XP, it said that it did not detect any hard disk. I used active boot disk to format it, and created three partitions. Also, it said no hard disk detected. I tried to install Vista, but I get I/O interface errors. Please tell me how to install XP again urgently.

Gaurav Kenue

A Your Windows XP refuses to install, most likely because of Windows XP not having the necessary drivers for the SATA controller on the laptop. Download the drivers from your laptop or motherboard manufacturer's site. You need to use a floppy to install drivers when the Windows XP installation begins. You can also use